

Grammar Escape Room 2

Escape Room 2: Detective Grammar

4th Grade | Subject-Verb Agreement, Pronouns, Commas

TEKS: 4.11D.vi, 4.11D.ix

Design Overview

- **Color Palette:** Noir gold (#FFD700), charcoal black (#1A1A2E), deep crimson (#8B0000), cream (#FFF8DC), magnifying glass amber
 - **Font:** Special Elite (headers — typewriter style), Lato (body)
 - **Characters:** Detective Rex (a fox in a trench coat & fedora), The Grammar Thief (shadowy figure)
 - **Interactive Mechanic:** Click correct answer → collect evidence. Wrong → Detective Rex gives a clue.
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SLIDE-BY-SLIDE BREAKDOWN

SLIDE 1 — Title Slide

Visual: Dark noir city skyline at night. A magnifying glass in center with the title inside it. Gold text on black. Silhouette of detective in corner. Rain streaks.

Text: > #  DETECTIVE GRAMMAR  > *Crack the Code. Solve the Crime.* > > Grade 4 | Grammar Escape Room > >  Someone stole the Golden Grammar Trophy. Can YOU solve the case?

SLIDE 2 — Case Briefing

Visual: A police bulletin board with red string connecting clues. Detective Rex stands beside it holding a file folder. Dim lighting, dramatic.

Text: > ## 📁 Case Briefing > > “Detective! I’m **Detective Rex**, and I need your sharp eyes! > > Last night, someone stole the **Golden Grammar Trophy** 🏆 from Grammar City Hall! We have 5 suspects, and the thief left **grammar mistakes** as clues at each crime scene. > > Visit **5 crime scenes**, fix the grammar errors, and collect **evidence letters**. Unscramble the letters to reveal the thief’s name! > > **Your Grammar Tools:** > - 📖 Subject-Verb Agreement > - 👤 Pronoun-Antecedent Agreement > - ✎ Comma Rules > > 🔍 *Click the magnifying glass to begin!* 🔍”

📌 SLIDE 3 — Evidence Tracker

Visual: An evidence board (corkboard style) with 5 pinned cards, each blank. Red string connects them. Manila folder at bottom.

Text: > ## 📁 EVIDENCE TRACKER > > Return here after each crime scene to record your evidence letter! > > | Scene 1 | Scene 2 | Scene 3 | Scene 4 | Scene 5 | > |:—:|:—:|:—:|:—:|:—:| > | | | | | > > **Unscrambled Name: ____ ** > > 🔴
 Scene 1: The Library → 🟡 Scene 2: The Park → 🟢 Scene 3: The Museum → 🔵 Scene 4: The Restaurant → 🟣 Scene 5: The School

🔴 SCENE 1: The Library (Subject-Verb Agreement)

📌 SLIDE 4 — Scene 1 Story

Visual: A dark library with overturned books. Crime scene tape across a shelf. Dust particles in light beams.

Text: > ## 🔴 Crime Scene 1: The Library > > The thief was spotted near the library! Books are scattered everywhere, and grammar errors were left behind. > > Detective Rex examines the scene: “These sentences have **subject-verb agreement** errors. The subject and verb must MATCH — singular with singular, plural with plural. Fix them to find your first clue!” > > 🧠 **Remember:** > - Singular subject → singular verb: “The dog **runs**.” > - Plural subject → plural verb: “The dogs **run**.”

SLIDE 5 — Scene 1 Challenge

Visual: Evidence notes (yellow sticky notes) with sentences. Gold/black answer buttons.

Text: > ##  Scene 1 Challenge: Subject-Verb Agreement > > **Choose the correct verb to complete each sentence.** > > **1.** The group of students ____ ready for the test. > - A) are > - B) is  > - C) were > > **2.** My brothers ____ soccer every Saturday. > - A) plays > - B) play  > - C) playing > > **3.** The cat and the dog ____ in the yard. > - A) runs > - B) run  > - C) is running > > **4.** Everyone in the class ____ a pencil. > - A) need > - B) needs  > - C) needing

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-B, 3-B, 4-B

SLIDE 5B — Scene 1 Hint

Text: > ##  Detective Rex's Clue: > “Look at the **subject** — is it singular or plural? Watch out for tricky subjects! ‘Group’ and ‘everyone’ are SINGULAR even though they refer to many people. ‘Cat AND dog’ = TWO things = PLURAL.” > >  *Try again, Detective!*

SLIDE 6 — Scene 1 Evidence

Visual: Rex holds up a glowing letter in an evidence bag.

Text: > ##  Scene 1 — Evidence Collected!  > > “Excellent work! Here’s your first evidence letter!” > > #  Your letter is: **R** > >  Record **R** on your Evidence Tracker! >  *Proceed to Scene 2!*

SCENE 2: The Park (Subject-Verb Agreement — Advanced)

SLIDE 7 — Scene 2 Story

Visual: A moonlit park with footprints in the grass. A bench knocked over. Noir lamppost lighting.

Text: > ##  Crime Scene 2: The Park > > Footprints lead through the park! More grammar errors were found scrawled on the park bench. > > “More subject-verb

agreement, but trickier this time! Watch for subjects that come AFTER the verb and sentences that try to confuse you!”

SLIDE 8 — Scene 2 Challenge

Text: > ## 🟡 Scene 2 Challenge: Tricky Subject-Verb Agreement > > **Choose the sentence that is CORRECT.** > > **1.** > - A) The box of chocolates were on the table. > - B) The box of chocolates was on the table. ✅ > > **2.** > - A) Neither the teacher nor the students was late. > - B) Neither the teacher nor the students were late. ✅ > > **3.** > - A) Here comes the marching band! ✅ > - B) Here come the marching band! > > **4.** > - A) The news are on at six o'clock. > - B) The news is on at six o'clock. ✅

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-B, 3-A, 4-B

SLIDE 8B — Scene 2 Hint

Text: > ## 🔍 Detective Rex's Clue: > “Find the TRUE subject! In ‘box of chocolates,’ the subject is BOX (singular), not chocolates. ‘Neither...nor’ — the verb matches the CLOSEST subject. ‘News’ looks plural but it’s SINGULAR!” > > 🔄 Try again!

SLIDE 9 — Scene 2 Evidence

Text: > ## ✅ Scene 2 — Evidence Collected! 🎉 > # 📄 Your letter is: **A** > 📝 Record **A** on your Evidence Tracker!

🟢 SCENE 3: The Museum (Pronoun-Antecedent Agreement)

SLIDE 10 — Scene 3 Story

Visual: A grand museum with a smashed display case. Red velvet ropes. Paintings on walls askew.

Text: > ## 🟢 Crime Scene 3: The Museum > > The thief broke into the Grammar Museum! The display of pronouns was smashed. > > “Pronouns must AGREE with the noun they replace — the **antecedent**. If the noun is singular, the pronoun must be singular. If plural, plural! Match them up!” > > 🧠 **Remember:** An **antecedent** is the

noun that a pronoun refers to. > - “**Maria** forgot **her** lunch.” (Maria = antecedent, her = pronoun)

SLIDE 11 — Scene 3 Challenge

Text: > ##  Scene 3 Challenge: Pronoun-Antecedent Agreement > > **Choose the correct pronoun.** > > **1.** Each student should bring ____ own supplies. > - A) their > - B) his or her  > - C) our > > **2.** The players celebrated ____ victory. > - A) his > - B) its > - C) their  > > **3.** Maria and José finished ____ project early. > - A) her > - B) his > - C) their  > > **4.** The dog wagged ____ tail happily. > - A) their > - B) its  > - C) his > > **5.** Somebody left ____ backpack in the hallway. > - A) their > - B) his or her  > - C) our

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-C, 3-C, 4-B, 5-B

SLIDE 11B — Hint

Text: > ##  Detective Rex’s Clue: > “Find the antecedent first! Is it singular or plural? Male, female, or neutral? ‘Each’ and ‘somebody’ are SINGULAR — use ‘his or her.’ ‘Players’ and ‘Maria and José’ are PLURAL — use ‘their.’ For animals/things, use ‘its.’”

SLIDE 12 — Scene 3 Evidence

Text: > ##  Scene 3 — Evidence Collected!  > #  Your letter is: **V** >  Record **V** on your Evidence Tracker!

SCENE 4: The Restaurant (Comma Usage)

SLIDE 13 — Scene 4 Story

Visual: A fancy restaurant with knocked-over wine glasses and scattered menus. Crime tape on the kitchen door.

Text: > ##  Crime Scene 4: The Restaurant > > Evidence was found at Café Grammar! The thief left notes with missing commas everywhere. > > “Commas are tiny but POWERFUL! They separate items in a list, come after introductory words, and join sentences with conjunctions. Find where the commas belong!” > >  **Comma Rules:** >

- **Lists:** I like dogs, cats, and fish. > - **Introductory words:** First, we went to the store.
- > - **Compound sentences:** I ran fast, but I still missed the bus.

SLIDE 14 — Scene 4 Challenge

Text: > ##  Scene 4 Challenge: Comma Usage > > **Where does the comma belong? Choose the correctly written sentence.** > > **1.** > - A) We need milk eggs and bread from the store. > - B) We need milk, eggs, and bread from the store.  > > **2.** > - A) After the storm, the rainbow appeared.  > - B) After the storm the rainbow appeared. > > **3.** > - A) I wanted to play outside but it was raining. > - B) I wanted to play outside, but it was raining.  > > **4.** > - A) Yes I would like some more please. > - B) Yes, I would like some more, please.  > > **5.** > - A) My favorite colors are blue, green, and purple.  > - B) My favorite colors are blue green and purple.

Correct Answers: 1-B, 2-A, 3-B, 4-B, 5-A

SLIDE 14B — Hint

Text: > ##  Detective Rex's Clue: > "Three big comma rules: 1) **Lists** of 3+ items need commas between them. 2) **Introductory words/phrases** at the start of a sentence get a comma after them. 3) When combining two complete sentences with AND, BUT, OR, SO — put a comma BEFORE the conjunction!"

SLIDE 15 — Scene 4 Evidence

Text: > ##  Scene 4 — Evidence Collected!  > #  Your letter is: **E** >  Record **E** on your Evidence Tracker!

SCENE 5: The School (Mixed Review)

SLIDE 16 — Scene 5 Story

Visual: A school hallway at night, lockers slightly open, one spotlight on a grammar error on the chalkboard. Eerie but exciting.

Text: > ##  Crime Scene 5: The School > > The final crime scene — Grammar Elementary! This is it. The trickiest challenges combine everything you've learned. > >

“You’ve almost cracked the case! This last scene mixes ALL three skills: subject-verb agreement, pronouns, AND commas. Get them right and we catch the thief!”

SLIDE 17 — Scene 5 Challenge

Text: > ##  Scene 5 Challenge: Mixed Grammar Review > > **Find the error in each sentence and choose the correction.** > > **1.** “The team are playing their best game of the season.” > - A) Change “are” to “is”  > - B) Change “their” to “its” > - C) No error > > **2.** “After school me and my friend walks to the park.” > - A) Change “me and my friend” to “my friend and I” and “walks” to “walk”  > - B) Change “walks” to “walked” > - C) Add a comma after “After school” only > > **3.** “Sarah brought her lunch but she forgot a drink.” > - A) Change “her” to “their” > - B) Add a comma after “lunch”  > - C) No error > > **4.** “Each of the boys need to bring their own helmet.” > - A) Change “need” to “needs” and “their” to “his”  > - B) Change “boys” to “boy” > - C) No error

Correct Answers: 1-A, 2-A, 3-B, 4-A

SLIDE 17B — Hint

Text: > ##  Detective Rex’s Final Clue: > “Read each sentence carefully. Check THREE things: 1) Does the subject match the verb? 2) Do the pronouns match their antecedents? 3) Are commas in the right places? One of these will be wrong in each sentence!”

SLIDE 18 — Scene 5 Evidence

Text: > ##  Scene 5 — Evidence Collected!  > #  Your letter is: N >  Record N on your Evidence Tracker!

FINAL PUZZLE

SLIDE 19 — Unscramble the Name

Visual: The evidence board now full. Red string connecting all letters. A spotlight shines on the unscramble puzzle. Dramatic music implied.

Text: > ##  CRACK THE CASE! > > You’ve collected all 5 evidence letters! Unscramble them to reveal the thief’s name: > > **Your Letters: R — A — V — E — N** > >

Unscramble: _ _ _ _ _ > > ## 🦋 The thief is: **RAVEN!** > > (Raven the Raccoon — the sneaky janitor at Grammar City Hall!) > > Type **RAVEN** in the text box to solve the case!
> > ➡ Click to close the case!

📌 SLIDE 20 — Case Closed!

Visual: Newspaper headline: “GRAMMAR THIEF CAUGHT!” Confetti. Detective Rex celebrating. Trophy restored.

Text: > ## 🎉 🔍 CASE CLOSED! 🔍 🎉 > > **THE GRAMMAR CITY GAZETTE** > > “GRAMMAR THIEF CAUGHT THANKS TO BRILLIANT YOUNG DETECTIVE!” > > You cracked the case and recovered the Golden Grammar Trophy! 🏆 > > ✅ Subject-Verb Agreement — MASTERED > ✅ Pronoun-Antecedent Agreement — MASTERED > ✅ Comma Usage — MASTERED > > *Grammar City is safe again, thanks to YOU!*

📌 SLIDE 21 — Certificate

Text: > ## 🏆 Certificate of Achievement > > **This certifies that** > > _____ > > **has successfully solved the case of the Grammar Thief > and is now an official Grammar City Detective!** 🔍 > > ★
Subject-Verb Agreement ★ Pronouns ★ Commas > > Date: _____ |
Detective Rex’s Signature: _____

TEACHER ANSWER KEY (Quick Reference)

Scene	Q#	Correct Answer
1 (Library)	1	B) is
1	2	B) play
1	3	B) run
1	4	B) needs
2 (Park)	1	B) was

Scene	Q#	Correct Answer
2	2	B) were
2	3	A) comes
2	4	B) is
3 (Museum)	1	B) his or her
3	2	C) their
3	3	C) their
3	4	B) its
3	5	B) his or her
4 (Restaurant)	1	B) with commas
4	2	A) comma after “storm”
4	3	B) comma before “but”
4	4	B) commas after “Yes” and before “please”
4	5	A) with commas
5 (School)	1	A) “is”
5	2	A) “my friend and I” + “walk”
5	3	B) comma after “lunch”
5	4	A) “needs” + “his”

Thief's Name: RAVEN (letters R-A-V-E-N)



Detective Grammar — Teacher Guide

Escape Room 2 | 4th Grade | 30–45 Minutes



Overview

Students solve a mystery by visiting 5 crime scenes and fixing grammar errors to collect evidence letters. Unscramble the letters to reveal the thief's name.

TEKS: 4.11D.vi (pronouns), 4.11D.ix (punctuation including commas)

Skills: Subject-verb agreement, pronoun-antecedent agreement, comma usage



How to Assign in Google Classroom

1. Open Google Classroom → Classwork → + **Create** → **Assignment**
2. Attach the Google Slides file → **“Make a copy for each student”**
3. Instructions: *“Work through each crime scene in order. Record your evidence letters on the Evidence Tracker (Slide 3). Unscramble the letters at the end to catch the thief!”*
4. Assign!



Timing

Setup	Activity	Wrap-Up
5 min	25–35 min	5–10 min

Wrap-Up Suggestion: Review Scene 5 (mixed review) together — it's the hardest and generates the best discussion.



Differentiation

Struggling Learners:

- Provide a grammar rules reference sheet (SVA, pronouns, commas)

- Allow partner work
- Focus on Scenes 1, 3, and 4 (skip Scene 2 which has tricky SVA)

Advanced Learners:

- Challenge: Find additional errors the detective “missed” (write their own)
- Time challenge: Complete in under 25 minutes
- Write a “Case Report” paragraph using correct SVA, pronouns, and commas

ELL Students:

- Pre-teach: subject, verb, pronoun, antecedent, comma
 - Allow native language grammar reference
 - Pair with bilingual buddy
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Center vs. Whole Class

Center:

- 1–2 rotation periods
- Self-directed, minimal teacher support needed
- Print Evidence Tracker for paper option

Whole Class:

- Project and discuss after each scene
 - Great for grammar review before assessments
 - Use “think-pair-share” for each challenge
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Extension Activities

1. **Write the News Article:** Students write a Grammar City Gazette article about the thief being caught — must use correct SVA, pronouns, and commas

2. **Create a New Crime Scene:** Students write their own Scene 6 with 4 grammar questions
3. **Pronoun Swap:** Give students a paragraph and have them replace nouns with correct pronouns
4. **Comma Surgery:** Give students unpunctuated paragraphs to add commas

Assessment

- Formative assessment for subject-verb agreement, pronoun usage, and comma rules
- Great pre-test/post-test activity for grammar unit
- Works as STAAR grammar prep (4th grade conventions)

Detective Grammar — Answer Key

Escape Room 2 | 4th Grade

Thief's Name: RAVEN (R-A-V-E-N)

Scene 1: The Library — Subject-Verb Agreement (Letter: R)

#	Sentence	Correct	Explanation
1	The group of students ____ ready.	is	“Group” is the subject (singular), not “students.”
2	My brothers ____ soccer every Saturday.	play	“Brothers” is plural → plural verb “play.”
3	The cat and the dog ____ in the yard.	run	Compound subject (cat AND dog) = plural.
4	Everyone in the class ____ a pencil.	needs	“Everyone” is always singular.

Common Mistakes: Students pick the verb that matches the nearest noun instead of the true subject. “Group of students” — students is NOT the subject; it’s part of a prepositional phrase.

🟡 Scene 2: The Park — Tricky SVA (Letter: A)

#	Correct Sentence	Explanation
1	The box of chocolates was on the table.	“Box” is singular. “Of chocolates” is a prepositional phrase.
2	Neither the teacher nor the students were late.	With “neither...nor,” verb matches the CLOSER subject (“students” = plural).
3	Here comes the marching band!	Inverted sentence — “band” is singular.
4	The news is on at six o’clock.	“News” is a singular noun despite the -s ending.

Common Mistakes: “Neither...nor” rule is the trickiest. Also, students think “news” is plural.

🟢 Scene 3: The Museum — Pronoun-Antecedent (Letter: V)

#	Sentence	Correct	Explanation
1	Each student...own supplies.	his or her	“Each” is singular → singular pronoun.
2	The players celebrated...victory.	their	“Players” is plural → “their.”
3	Maria and José finished...project.	their	Two people = plural → “their.”

#	Sentence	Correct	Explanation
4	The dog wagged...tail.	its	Animal/thing → “its” (no apostrophe!).
5	Somebody left... backpack.	his or her	“Somebody” is singular indefinite pronoun.

Common Mistakes: Using “their” for singular indefinite pronouns (each, somebody, everyone). While common in speech, standard grammar uses “his or her.” Also: “it’s” vs. “its” confusion.

Scene 4: The Restaurant — Commas (Letter: E)

#	Correct	Rule Applied
1	milk, eggs, and bread	Commas in a series/list
2	After the storm, the rainbow...	Comma after introductory phrase
3	...play outside, but it was raining.	Comma before conjunction in compound sentence
4	Yes, I would like some more, please.	Comma after introductory word + before “please”
5	blue, green, and purple	Commas in a series/list

Common Mistakes: Forgetting the comma before the conjunction in compound sentences. Also, students often omit the Oxford comma (the one before “and” in a list) — either convention is acceptable, but consistency matters.

Scene 5: The School — Mixed Review (Letter: N)

#	Sentence	Error	Correction	Explanation
1	The team are playing...	SVA	“are” → “is”	“Team” is singular collective noun.
2	...me and my friend walks...	SVA + pronoun	“My friend and I walk”	“I” not “me” as subject; compound subject = plural verb.
3	Sarah brought her lunch but she...	Comma	Add comma: “lunch, but”	Compound sentence needs comma before “but.”
4	Each of the boys need...their...	SVA + pronoun	“needs...his”	“Each” is singular → singular verb and pronoun.

Common Mistakes: Q2 has TWO errors, which is the hardest. Students often catch one but miss the other.